

LEONG UTEK

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EDUCATION

National University of Singapore, Singapore

PhD, Psychology.

Thesis: “Investigating the nature of associations between a core cognitive vulnerability and internalizing psychopathology”

Advisor: Associate Professor Ryan Hong.

Nanyang Technological University, Singapore

B.Soc.Sc. with Honours (Highest Distinction), Psychology.

Thesis: “Psychological predictors of short-term lower-limb orthotic device adherence: an exploratory study”

Advisors: Associate Professor Ryo Kitada and Dr Kinjal Doshi.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Duke-NUS Medical School, Singapore

Sung Lab

Research Fellow Jan 2026 – Present

Graduate Research Assistant Jan 2025 – Dec 2025

Duke-NUS Medical School, Singapore

A/Prof Bibhas Chakraborty’s Research Lab

Graduate Research Assistant Sep 2021 – Aug 2024

National University of Singapore, Singapore

Personality & Psychopathology Lab

Graduate Research Assistant Jun 2022 – Dec 2022

Singapore General Hospital, Singapore

Department of Psychology

Associate Clinical Research Coordinator	Jan 2021 – Jun 2021
Clinical Research Intern	Aug 2018 – Jun 2019

Nanyang Technological University, Singapore

NTU Touch Lab (now the Kobe Multisensory Lab)

Student Researcher	Aug 2018 – Jun 2019
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TEACHING EXPERIENCE

National University of Singapore, Singapore

Department of Psychology

Networks in Psychology (PL4245)	Semester 1, AY24/25
Introduction to Clinical Psychology (PL3257)	Semester 1, AY22/23
Abnormal Psychology (PL3106)	Semester 2, AY21/22
Biological Psychology (PL3102)	Semester 1, AY21/22

PUBLICATIONS

1. Ebrahimi, O. V., Freichel, R., **Leong, U.**, Majeed, N. M., & Epskamp, S. (2025). A Tutorial on Confirmatory Network Analysis. *In preparation*.
2. Pasqualotto, A., **Leong, U.**, & Kitada, R. (2025). Touching soft materials slows affective visual processing. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 16, 1644393. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2025.1644393>
3. Zainal, N. H., Liu, X., **Leong, U.**, Yan, X., & Chakraborty, B. (2025). Bridging Innovation and Equity: Advancing Public Health Through Just-in-Time Adaptive Interventions. *Annual Review of Public Health*, 46(1), 43–68. <https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev-publhealth-071723-103909>
4. **Leong, U.**, Epskamp, S., Isvoranu, A.-M., Angulo-Brunet, A., & Hong, R. Y. (2025). Associations Between a Transdiagnostic Core Vulnerability and Internalizing Symptoms: A Network Analysis. *Cognitive Therapy and Research*, 49(2), 291–301. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10608-024-10524-7> [OSF]
5. **Leong, U.**, & Chakraborty, B. (2023). Participant Engagement in Microrandomized Trials of mHealth Interventions: Scoping Review. *JMIR MHealth and UHealth*, 11, e44685. <https://doi.org/10.2196/44685> [OSF]

REGISTERED REPORTS

1. **Leong, U.**, Chan, E. H. L., Yau, W. T., Ng, W. Y., Chim, T. W., Yeung, W., Tam, K. Y. Y., & Feldman, G. (2024). On the moralization of vegetarianism and differences between health and

moral vegetarians: Registered Report replicating and extending Rozin et al. (1997) [Stage 1]. *Open Science Framework*. <https://osf.io/rac6q> [Stage 1 in-principle acceptance] [OSF]

PREPRINTS

1. **Leong, U.**, Seah, F. E., Epskamp, S., Zainal, N., & Hong, R. Y. (2025). Investigating the Associations among Core Cognitive Vulnerability, Internalizing Symptoms, and Negative Situational Experiences: A Longitudinal Network Analysis. *PsyArXiv*. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/2xey7_v1 [OSF]

PRESENTATIONS

Presenting authors are underlined.

1. **Leong, U.**, Rajah, M., Sung, S. C., Wild, J., Nadarajan, G. D., Ng, X. Y., Tan, J., Oh, J. (2026, July 15-17). Internet-Delivered Cognitive Resilience Training for Paramedics in Singapore During the COVID-19 Pandemic: A Randomized Controlled Trial [Conference presentation]. Biennial International Congress on Mental Health 2026, Singapore.
2. **Leong, U.**, Epskamp, S., Isvoranu, A., Angulo-Brunet, A., & Hong, R. Y. (2024, July 21-26). Associations Between a Transdiagnostic Core Vulnerability and Internalizing Symptoms: A Network Analysis [Poster presentation]. 33rd International Congress of Psychology, Prague, Czech Republic.
3. Henderson, S. L., Sugumar, L., **Leong, U.**, & Doshi, K. (2020, November 5-8). Evaluating mindfulness self-report questionnaires for scale development in a Singapore context: A focus group discussion [Conference presentation]. The Mind & Life 2020 Contemplative Research Conference, Singapore.

AWARDS

1. Graduate Students' Teaching Award (Semester 1, AY24/25)
2. Top 3 Oral Presenter, Biennial International Congress on Mental Health 2026

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewed for: JMIR Aging, JMIR Mental Health, JMIR Research Protocols, Internet Interventions